

Heart Disease Prevention

HEART DISEASE PREVENTION

Heart Disease Facts:

Heart disease is the leading cause of death in the United States. Prevention is crucial and can significantly reduce risk.

Types of Heart Disease:

1. Coronary Artery Disease (CAD) - Most common type, plaque buildup in arteries
2. Heart Failure - Heart can't pump enough blood
3. Arrhythmias - Irregular heartbeat
4. Valvular Heart Disease - Problems with heart valves

Risk Factors You Cannot Change:

- Age
- Sex
- Family history
- Race/ethnicity

Risk Factors You Can Change:

- High blood pressure
- High cholesterol
- Smoking
- Obesity
- Physical inactivity
- Diabetes
- Stress

Prevention Strategies:

Nutrition:

- Mediterranean diet
- Limit saturated fats (less than 5% of calories)
- Eliminate trans fats
- Increase fiber (25-30g daily)
- Limit sodium to less than 2,300mg daily

Exercise:

- 150 minutes of moderate aerobic activity per week
- Strength training 2 days per week
- Flexibility exercises

Screening:

- Cholesterol screening every 4-6 years
- Blood pressure monitoring
- Blood sugar screening
- EKG if symptoms present

Signs of Heart Attack:

- Chest pain or pressure

- Shortness of breath
- Pain in arm, neck, jaw
- Nausea or dizziness

Action: Call 911 immediately if experiencing these symptoms